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Over the years, the demands from management professionals have changed from purely functional skills to developing a holistic understanding of the business which values soft skills, leadership qualities and good communication skills. Globalisation will require the new-age MBAs to have a greater reality orientation and also the ability to work in varied environments across cultures and countries. Language skills will be high in demand and a better understanding of the political and economic history of various countries will be prized. The complexity of decision-making is intricately connected with transparency, corporate social responsibility, economy and environment; and your attitude towards them matters. Business administration is a part of society and it should not take you away from the real customers and the real issues. That is why the industry demands a consciousness about things around you. Social issues such as corruption and pollution will require a definitive point of view from the MBA graduates.



LET'S CONQUER THE WORLD:
Use of technology for everyday
teaching is likely to increase

a market dominated by Asian countries. JK Business School, New Delhi, for example, has made it mandatory for its PGP students to acquire working knowledge of Chinese whereas students at the Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies (NMIMS), Mumbai, can choose which foreign language they want to study as part of its full-time MBA in Pharmaceuticals Management.

An intellectual pool from all over the world, including international faculty and students, will be created. Student exchange programmes as well as study tours abroad on a semester-basis will become a part of the MBA programme in order to facilitate the international experience.

Age of specialisation

As the Indian economy is growing, newer sectors are opening up for management. Areas like retail, biotechnology, NGOs, agribusiness and hospitals have shown unprecedented demand for managers with sector-specific focus. To meet this demand, the new-age MBA will have to become more specialised. Defining it as the need of the times to come, Samir K. Barua, director, IIM-Ahmedabad, says, "In another 10 years, a much larger proportion of MBA programmes would become

specialised programmes with focus on a niche area." So, you might have specialists being churned out in areas like politics or relationship management or home management.

With increasing awareness in the corporate sector about its responsibility towards the society, MBA programmes will also prepare candidates to provide "global solutions for local problems". Tomorrow's MBA would be more "inclusive", focusing not just on the immediate corporate client but on society at large. Says Mudit Kapoor, assistant professor of economics and public policy at the Indian School of Business (ISB), "Future MBA programmes will provide solutions which benefit the corporate world and provide business-like solutions for social problems."

Citing the example of ISB's elective course in micro finance, that focuses on how to do banking with low-income households and is steadily gaining popularity among the students, Kapoor states that this is just one of the many ways in which MBA programmes will emphasise inclusive growth. Says Pradyumana Khokle, faculty, IIM-A, "MBAs will have to be more aware of the society in which they operate."

The programmes will focus on areas in the society to which future